

UNHRC ? UN Human Rights Council

AGENDA:

Deliberation on the normalisation of civilian as 'collateral damage' and its compatibility with international human rights obligations.

NIRMAAN MODEL UNITED NATIONS 2026

August 8-9, 2026 | Delhi NCR

Indraja Foundation

BACKGROUND

The UN Human Rights Council (UNHRC) is an inter-governmental body within the United Nations system responsible for strengthening the promotion and protection of human rights around the globe. It was established in 2006, replacing the former Commission on Human Rights.

KEY ISSUES TO RESEARCH

1. Collateral Damage Doctrine: The legal and ethical frameworks surrounding civilian casualties in armed conflict, including the principles of distinction, proportionality, and precaution under International Humanitarian Law (IHL).
2. Urban Warfare: The increasing trend of military operations in densely populated areas and its devastating impact on civilian populations.
3. Autonomous Weapons: The emergence of AI-driven weapons systems and the question of accountability for civilian casualties.
4. Media & Documentation: The role of journalism and international monitoring bodies in documenting civilian casualties and holding states accountable.
5. Accountability Mechanisms: Existing mechanisms (ICC, ICJ, fact-finding missions) and their effectiveness in addressing violations.

RECOMMENDED READINGS

- Geneva Conventions (1949) and Additional Protocols
- ICRC, "International Humanitarian Law and the Challenges of Contemporary Armed Conflicts" (2019)
- UN OHCHR Reports on Civilian Casualties in Recent Conflicts
- Amnesty International, "The State of the World's Human Rights" (Latest Edition)
- Human Rights Watch Country Reports

POSITION PAPER GUIDELINES

Delegates must present:

- Their country's military engagement history and civilian protection record
- National legislation on rules of engagement
- Stance on accountability mechanisms for civilian harm
- Proposals for strengthening civilian protection in armed conflict

RULES OF PROCEDURE

Standard UNHRC rules apply with formal debate, moderated and unmoderated caucuses, and resolution drafting.